



“COLLABORATIVE” IS NOT “SAFE”

Universal Robots’ own words: cobots alone are not collaborative — only cobot applications can be. The 2025 revision of the international standard deleted the term “collaborative robot” for exactly this reason.

The tool on the end is NOT protected by the robot’s safety system.

The arm is force-limited. The gripper, the blade, the hot iron it is holding are not monitored at all. And force limiting caps force, not pressure — a point concentrates the same force into a tiny area and punctures skin.

Slow does not mean gentle

Near full extension, or working close to its own base, the arm can deliver high force at low speed. You cannot judge the danger by how fast it looks.

- UR3 reaches 500 mm. UR5 reaches 850 mm. Know which one you are standing next to.
- Support the arm before releasing the brakes. It falls.
- Free-drive is a one-person job. Nobody leans in.
- Change the tool and the risk assessment has to be redone.